



LME KNITTING PATTERN



RO RO RO FOOTBALL CUSHION



FOOTBALL NET, TERRACES AND RO RO RO

A soft supporter's cushion with a football net, terraces and «RO RO RO» knitted all the way around the cushion. The pattern runs right round, so both sides come out the same. The pattern below is written for white, navy and red, like the original cushion. See page 3 for other colour combinations.



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Reconstructed from an original cushion knitted by Renate's mum



TIPS: Read the whole pattern through before you start. Knit a gauge swatch, especially when you switch yarn, because cotton and acrylic can behave differently.

BEFORE YOU START

The cushion cover is knitted in the round on a circular needle, from the bottom up. First you knit a plain flap about 12 cm long. Then comes the lower RO band, the football net, the red terrace tops and the upper RO band. The pattern runs all the way round the cushion, so both sides come out the same.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit a cushion cover in the round on a circular needle
- To combine cotton and acrylic of the same thickness
- To follow simple colour charts
- To knit vertical and horizontal lines that form a football net
- To make a practical cushion opening with an inner flap

HOW HARD IS IT?

A little practised. You should be able to cast on, knit stockinette in the round, change colour and follow a chart. The long stretches in the net need the floats kept loose.

Place a marker at the start of the round and a second marker after 80 stitches. Then you can always see where each side of the cushion begins.

ABOUT THE RECONSTRUCTION AND COLOURS

ABOUT THE RECONSTRUCTION

The original pattern took shape as the cushion was being knitted. The pattern has therefore been reconstructed from the finished cushion and information from the person who knitted it. Always measure as you go and fit the height to your inner cushion pad.

OTHER COLOUR COMBINATIONS



The cover shows the cushion in white, navy and red, the colours the pattern below is written for. It works just as well in teal, yellow and green (the very first colourway) or other combinations, for example red, white and blue like the Norwegian flag.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

Reynolds Saucy, 100% mercerised cotton. American yarn made in Brazil. The original yarn's label recommends 5 mm needles. The original cushion is knitted on 4.5 mm because the knitter knits a little loosely.

Colour

Use

○ White	main colour
● Navy	RO letters and football net
● Red	terrace tops and dot band

Holly from Rusta, 100% acrylic, 50 g. Soft, lint-free yarn, about the same thickness as Saucy. Nice for one of the pattern colours if you want to mix in some acrylic.

The yarn amount from the original piece was not recorded. Have plenty of white main colour and at least one ball of each pattern colour. If you sell yarn kits, the usage must be checked by a test swatch and weighed first.

ALTERNATIVE YARN

Use a smooth cotton or acrylic yarn that gives the same gauge. Choose a yarn meant for 4.5–5 mm needles. All the colours should be about the same thickness.

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 4.5 mm circular needle, 80 cm
- Tapestry needle, scissors and tape measure
- Two stitch markers
- 45 × 45 cm inner cushion pad
- Optional, for closing: snap fasteners, ribbon (bought or crocheted), or just needle and thread
- Optional: ready-made football badge

The yarn label recommends 5 mm needles, but 4.5 mm gave the right look in the original. If you knit tightly, 5 mm may suit you better.

GAUGE AND MEASUREMENTS

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

About 18 stitches = 10 cm in stockinette in the round. With 80 stitches on each side the cushion cover comes out about 44–45 cm wide.

Knit a swatch at least 12 × 12 cm. Wash and dry it the way you plan to treat the cushion cover. Then measure across the middle of the swatch.

- More than 18 stitches over 10 cm: try 5 mm needles.
- Fewer than 18 stitches over 10 cm: try 4 mm needles.
- About 18 stitches: use 4.5 mm needles and get going.

Measurement	Value
Inner cushion pad	45 × 45 cm
Width, each side	approx. 44–45 cm
Visible height	approx. 45 cm
Inner flap	approx. 12 cm
Stitches around	160 st = 80 st per side

Measure the height while the cover lies flat. Stop when the visible part from the fold edge to the top is 45 cm.

GLOSSARY AND STRUCTURE

Term	Means
st	stitch
round	one whole lap around
k	knit
p	purl
MC	white main colour
float	the thread that runs on the back when the colour is not in use
repeat	the stitches or rounds that are repeated

HOW THE CUSHION IS BUILT UP

- 1 12 cm plain flap for the cushion opening
- 2 Lower white field with navy RO motifs
- 3 Navy football net with white squares
- 4 Red terrace tops against a white background
- 5 Upper white band with navy RO motifs
- 6 White top, cast off and crocheted or sewn together

PART 1: FLAP AND LOWER EDGE

- 1 Cast on 160 stitches in white main colour on a 4.5 mm circular needle.
- 2 Check that the cast-on edge is not twisted. Join in the round and place a marker at the start of the round.
- 3 Knit 80 stitches, and place a second marker. The work is now divided into two matching sides of 80 stitches each.
- 4 Knit stockinette in the round in white until the work measures about 12 cm. This becomes the flap on the inside of the cushion cover.
- 5 Knit 1 round purl as a fold edge. From here the visible part of the cushion is measured.
- 6 Knit 2 rounds knit in white.

THE OPENING AT THE BOTTOM

When the cushion is finished, the plain 12 cm section is folded inward. Close it however you like, all three work equally well: fasten the flap with a few stitches on each side, sew on 2–3 snap fasteners, or use ribbon (bought or crocheted) tied in a bow. No sewing is required beyond whichever you choose.

Do not sew the whole lower edge shut. The cover should be removable and used like an ordinary cushion cover.

PART 2: LOWER RO BAND

The letters are knitted in navy on a white background. Each RO motif is 8 stitches wide and 7 rounds tall.

PLACEMENT ON EACH SIDE

10 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 10 white st

That comes to exactly 80 stitches. Repeat the same placement on the other side.

CHART: NAVY RO ON WHITE

T	T	T	Y	Y	T	T	T	7
T	Y	Y	T	Y	T	Y	T	6
T	Y	Y	T	Y	T	Y	T	5
T	T	T	Y	Y	T	Y	T	4
T	Y	T	Y	Y	T	Y	T	3
T	Y	Y	T	Y	T	Y	T	2
T	Y	Y	T	Y	T	T	T	1

Read the chart from the bottom up. Because you are knitting in the round, each round is read from right to left.

AFTER THE BAND

Knit 1 round white, 1 round alternating 1 navy and 1 white stitch, then white until the section above the letters measures about 7–8 cm.

Catch the floats if they run longer than five stitches. Keep them loose, or the cushion will pull itself in.

PART 3: THE FOOTBALL NET

Switch to navy. Knit 2 rounds navy, then 1 round white and 1 round navy.

NET REPEAT

The repeat is 5 stitches wide and 5 rounds tall. Repeat it 32 times around and 6 times in height.

W	W	W	W	W	5
W	G	G	G	G	4
W	G	G	G	G	3
W	G	G	G	G	2
W	G	G	G	G	1

On the four bottom rounds of each repeat, knit 1 white, 4 navy all the way round. On the fifth round, knit every stitch white. This forms one horizontal net line.

Repeat these five rounds six times, or until the net section measures about 13–14 cm.

Finish with 1 round of 1 white/4 navy, 1 round white and 2 rounds navy.

The white, vertical stitches sit directly above one another. Count from the start of the round so the net does not shift.

PART 4: TERRACES AND DOT BAND

Above the net you knit red tops against a white background. The repeat runs over 10 stitches and is repeated 16 times around.

CHART: RED TOPS

T	T	T	T	G	G	T	T	T	T	5
T	T	T	G	G	G	G	T	T	T	4
T	T	G	G	G	G	G	G	T	T	3
T	G	G	G	G	G	G	G	G	T	2
G	G	G	G	G	G	G	G	G	G	1

Knit the chart from the bottom up. To get the handmade, uneven look of the original cushion, you can knit every other top one round taller.

CONTINUE IN WHITE

Knit 8–10 rounds white. Then knit a dot band: 1 red stitch, 3 white stitches around. Knit a further 5–6 rounds white.

Lay the work flat and check the height before you start the upper RO band.

PART 5: UPPER RO BAND

Same colours as the lower band: the letters are knitted in navy on a white background.

PLACEMENT ON EACH SIDE

10 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 5 white st – RO – 10 white st

Repeat the same placement on side number two.

CHART: NAVY RO ON WHITE

Y	Y	Y	T	T	Y	Y	Y	7
Y	T	T	Y	T	Y	T	Y	6
Y	T	T	Y	T	Y	T	Y	5
Y	Y	Y	T	T	Y	T	Y	4
Y	T	Y	T	T	Y	T	Y	3
Y	T	T	Y	T	Y	T	Y	2
Y	T	T	Y	T	Y	Y	Y	1

After the chart, knit 2 rounds white, 2 rounds navy and 1 dot band with 1 navy and 3 white stitches around.

Carry on in white until the visible section, measured from the purl round at the fold edge, is about 45 cm.

PART 6: FINISHING AND ASSEMBLY

- 1 Cast off loosely across all 160 stitches.
- 2 Lay the cover flat with the markers on each side. Check that 80 stitches lie on the front and 80 on the back.
- 3 Crochet the cast-off edge of the front and back together with a crochet hook: work the hook through both layers and single crochet all the way across the top. If you prefer a needle and thread, you can sew them together with mattress stitch instead, it gives the same result.
- 4 Weave in all loose ends on the inside. Check that the floats lie loose and do not pull the pattern in.
- 5 Fold the plain section, about 12 cm, into the cushion cover.
- 6 Insert the cushion pad. Close the opening however you chose in part 1: a few stitches, snap fasteners, or ribbon tied in a bow.

OPTIONAL BADGE

The original cushion has a ready-made football badge with the Norwegian flag sewn onto one side. The badge is decoration and is not part of the knitting pattern itself.

CARE AND FINAL CHECK

CARE

Because the cushion combines mercerised cotton and acrylic, it should be washed following the gentlest yarn's recommendation. Wash the cover separately on a gentle cycle, about 30°C. Use a wash bag. Do not tumble dry. Shape the cover and let it dry flat.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ The cover measures about 45 × 45 cm without the flap
- ☐ The pattern runs all the way round and matches on both sides
- ☐ There are five RO motifs on each side in both bands
- ☐ The football net has straight, white lines
- ☐ The floats lie loose on the inside
- ☐ The top is neatly crocheted or sewn together
- ☐ The flap is fastened at the sides and the opening works

Before the pattern goes on sale, one test knit of the charts and a weigh-in of the yarn usage is recommended. Then exact yarn amounts can be added to the next edition.

Congratulations, you have knitted your very own football cushion!



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